Standard & Poor's 500 change. The strong general market upswing (13%) in bull markets helped carry along the chart pattern's average rise (50%). I can't say whether that's really true, but a rising tide lifts all boats. I'm beginning to dislike that cliché, though, because I use it too much. I guess it wouldn't be a cliché if people like me didn't use it.

Days to ultimate high. How long does it take price to top out? Answer: about 7 months. If you want to reach the ultimate high, it will take a long time for a stock to rise 50%. The duration is an average, though. The median is just 71 days (about 10 weeks).

How many change trend? Out of 39 chart patterns, the Eve & Eve double bottom ranks 8 where a rank of 1 is best. I like to see values above 50%, and this chart pattern far exceeds that. By the way, I added this measure to count how many double bottoms see price rise more than 20% after the breakout. It was my attempt to determine if a chart pattern led to a sustained trend.

Table 29.3 shows failure rates for double bottoms. Let me give you some examples of how you read this table. In bull markets, 12% of the patterns failed to see price rise more than 5% after the breakout. Twenty-three percent didn't exceed a 10% rise.

Notice how failure rates nearly triple (to 32% from 12%) for rises of no more than 15%. Half the patterns will stop climbing before reaching 30%. This alarming progression of failures is typical for all chart patterns. It emphasizes that making money using chart patterns isn't as simple as buying the first one you see.